

History of Media Studies Newsletter July 2026

Welcome to the 60th edition of the *History of Media Studies Newsletter*. The monthly email, assembled by Dave Park, Jeff Pooley, and Pete Simonson, maintains a loose affiliation with the *History of Media Studies* journal and the *Working Group on the History of Media Studies*. Please **contact us** with any questions, suggestions, or items.

1. Working Group on the History of Media Studies

Join us for the next remote session devoted to discussing working papers with authors. Hosted by the *Consortium for History of Science, Technology and Medicine* (CHSTM). Open to anyone interested in the history of the media studies fields. **Instructions to join** are [here](#).

The Working Group is off for the summer. We will resume in September with a draft paper from Andrew Williams (University of Pennsylvania).

Questions? **Contact us***

2. Conferences, Calls & Announcements

If you have a call or announcement relevant to the history of media studies, please **contact us**.

1. CFP: *The Film-Philosophies of Stanley Cavell and Gilles Deleuze*

- In the latter half of the 20th century, philosophers Gilles Deleuze and Stanley Cavell developed parallel ideas on film's distinct capacity for producing thought. While Deleuze and Cavell's respective influence continues to grow across the Atlantic and indeed globally, and their texts on cinema are by now considered seminal works in the field of film-philosophy, their ideas have only in exceptional cases been brought to bear on one another productively.

This special issue of *Philosophies*, edited by Jeroen Gerrits (Binghamton University, SUNY) and Sandra Laugier (Université Paris 1 Panthéon Sorbonne), seeks to explore generative conjunctions and differences between Cavell and Deleuze's transversal thought in light of this changing media landscape, with a focus on the pertinence of their works on film and media for philosophy.

- **Deadline:** 1 August 2026
- **More details**

2. CFP: *Intersections of psychological research and psychotherapeutic practices*

- This special issue of the *Journal of the History of the Behavioral Sciences* seeks to contribute to the emerging historiography of psychotherapy, focusing on the "Intersections of Psychological Research and Psychotherapeutic Practices." This topic originates from the 10th International Workshop on Historical Epistemology (University of Lübeck, 2025), which brought together scholars drawing on historical epistemology and related approaches that integrate the philosophy and history of science to analyze how knowledge and therapeutic practices concerning the psyche have been co-constructed across experimental, clinical and cultural contexts. By examining these intertwined epistemic and normative dimensions, this special issue aims to understand the history of psychotherapy as a crossroads of reciprocal production and continual transformation among gns psychological knowledge, research practices, techniques of the self, social institutions, and modern forms of subjectivity.
- **Deadline:** 30 September 2026
- **More details**

3. *Third International History of Knowledge Conference: "Decentering the History of Knowledge"*

- The third History of Knowledge Conference will take place in Utrecht on 25-27 August 2027. The conference follows the successful first international History of Knowledge Conference in Porto in 2023, and the second edition, hosted by the Lund Centre for the History of Knowledge in 2025. Utrecht University is home of the Descartes Centre for the History and Philosophy of Sciences and the Humanities, and the field's flagship Journal for the History

of Knowledge. In recent years, history of knowledge has developed into a vibrant field of interdisciplinary research and scholarship around the globe. The History of Knowledge Conference will gather scholars with a diversity of backgrounds to further develop the field and its impact on other disciplines and society. Fostering inclusivity, we welcome all scholars working on the history of knowledge in the broadest sense. The central theme of the conference will be: "Decentering the History of Knowledge."

- Conference dates: 25–27 August 2027
- **Deadline:** A call for papers will be published in the Fall of 2026.
- **More details**

4. *ESHHS Early Career Award*

- All students who presented a paper at either the 2025 Paris or 2026 Vienna conferences are eligible to submit their paper. Early career researchers who completed their PhD no more than 5 years prior to the date of submission are also eligible to submit their paper as long as they do not hold a permanent/tenured university position (or equivalent). Candidates must be the sole presenter of the paper at the conference and the sole or first author of the paper. They must be a member of ESHHS at the time of submission, and cannot be awarded the ECA if they have won the Cheiron Young Scholar Award for the same paper.
- **Deadline:** 15 October 2026
- **More details**

3. The Journal

History of Media Studies encourages **submissions (en español)** on the history of research, education, and reflective knowledge about media and communication—as expressed through academic institutions; through commercial, governmental, and non-governmental organizations; and through “alter-traditions” of thought and practice often excluded from the academic mainstream.

- The journal is **soliciting proposals** for a special section on the histories of publishing in the media, communication, and film studies fields. The focus of the special section is on the role of publishers—both commercial and

nonprofit—in these fields' development. Proposals of around 1000 words, including references, should be sent by September 15, 2026. See the **CFP** for more details.

4. New Publications

Works listed here are newly published, or new to the *bibliography*.

The *History of Communication Research Bibliography* is a project of the *Annenberg School for Communication Library Archives* (ASCLA) at the University of Pennsylvania.

1. Ali, Christopher. "Everyday praxis: Political economy, feminism, and the ethics of policy intervention." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 337--350.

<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0012>.

ABSTRACT: *In this article, I argue that within his seminal Political Economy of Communication (2009) Vincent Mosco articulated a unique vision of praxis for the field of critical political economy of communication (CPEC). Calling it 'everyday praxis', I argue CPEC provides an umbrella under which everyday life and critical feminism can be brought together to offer a grounded approach to what Mosco calls the 'unity of research and action'. From here, Mosco's everyday praxis gives CPEC scholars the language and the normative foundations to offer interventions, suggestions and alternatives to the status quo that can lead towards a more socially just and equitable future. I argue that Mosco's definition of praxis is particularly germane to studies of communication policy and use the example of 'lived policy' to illustrate how praxis can operate through an ethic of policy intervention that privileges everyday life and community voices.*

2. Barać, Stanislava. "Feminist periodical studies in Yugoslavia/Serbia: From individual interpretation to disciplinary transformative enterprise." *The Journal of Modern Periodical Studies* 17, no. 1 (2026): 104--126.

<https://doi.org/10.5325/jmodeperistud.17.1.0104>.

ABSTRACT: *This article examines Slobodanka Peković's pioneering research on women's magazines in the context of the history of the Periodical Studies Department at the Institute for Literature and Art in Belgrade and of global transformations in periodical studies. The department nurtured a noncanonical approach to the study of Serbian literary periodicals and thus*

to Serbian literature by focusing not only on literary journals but also on marginal magazines, those created by ethnic minorities, immigrants, or intended for children. The article explains how Peković's project proposal from the late 1970s for research on nineteenth- and twentieth-century magazines, entitled "The Presence and Contribution of Women Writers in the Modern Serbian Literature," was rejected by the Scientific Council of the Institute for Literature and Art, but was effectively implemented within the department much later when better circumstances for feminist research arose. Even before that occurred, and without the opportunity for collective research organized by the institution, Peković conducted the work individually and developed her method of interpreting women's contributions in historically influential literary and women's magazines. The article stresses how studies of women's and feminist periodicals can lead periodical scholars to the globally relevant methodological questions of their discipline.

3. Brlek, Sašo Slaček. "The digital sublime and the hidden abode: Deepening the dialogue between political economy of communication and labour process theory on digital labour." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 485--497.

<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0022>.

ABSTRACT: *This focused reflection responds to calls to renew Vincent Mosco's political economy by extending his insights through the broader Labour Process Theory (LPT) tradition. While LPT in communication studies is often reduced to Braverman's deskilling thesis, this essay argues that Friedman, Edwards, Burawoy and Davies provide additional essential concepts for analysing digital labour in the era of the cloud and generative AI. Read through Mosco's concepts of spatialisation and the digital sublime, these contributions clarify how algorithmic workplaces and platform labour are organised through segmented regimes of control, the institutional production (and breakdown) of consent and gendered and racialised hierarchies that render key forms of maintenance and data work invisible. This article therefore offers an integrated lens for understanding how contemporary infrastructures reconfigure the boundaries of the 'factory' at planetary scale.*

4. Child, Jeffrey T., and Dawn O. Braithwaite. "Communication privacy management theory: History of development, research trends, and future applications." *Journal of Family Communication* 26, no. 3 (2026): 268--283.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/15267431.2026.2686132>.

ABSTRACT: *Communication privacy management (CPM) theory has been tested and refined for over forty years. In this article we chart the history of development of the theory across this span of time. Then, we review research utilizing CPM theory in the family in the areas of parent-child privacy boundaries and privacy invasions, difficult disclosure processes that happen in diverse families, military deployment, adoption-related communication, and health communication within the family. We end the essay by addressing the future of CPM theory and research related to the family. This includes recommending scholars expand the theory by: exploring privacy management from more interconnected vantage points within the same family system; charting life and privacy regulation in our modern digital information society; and exploring privacy regulation in more non-Western settings and applications.*

5. Corrigan, Thomas F. "Vincent Mosco's metatheory and the media and global polycrises." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 261–271. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0006>.

ABSTRACT: *Tooze (2022) and others have argued that humanity confronts a global 'polycrisis' – the compounding entanglement of political, economic, ecological and technological crises across global systems. Yet leading polycrisis scholarship has largely ignored media and communication systems' role in those crises and entanglements. This essay revisits Vincent Mosco's metatheory, as articulated in *The Political Economy of Communication* (1996), arguing that it provides valuable ontological and epistemological guidance for addressing the media blindspot in polycrisis studies. Mosco's open, processual ontology and realist, inclusive and critical epistemology can help us study and explain the mutual constitution of media and global polycrises while guiding emancipatory interventions.*

6. Dick, Leslie. "Introduction to Peter Wollen dossier." *Framework: The Journal of Cinema and Media* 66, no. 1 (2025): 9--10. <https://doi.org/10.1353/frm.2025.a994380>.

ABSTRACT: *[first paragraph, in lieu of abstract] I met Peter Wollen in London in 1984, introduced by our mutual friend Lynne Tillman, and after some time together, we married in 1993. I miss him very much. Yet I am happy that Peter's work continues to resonate, especially within the context of Framework, where he published numerous essays over the years. Peter Wollen (1938–2019) was a film theorist, filmmaker, curator, teacher, and writer. His first book, *Signs and Meaning in the Cinema*, became a classic of film theory and appeared in four different iterations (1969, 1972, 1998, 2013). With Mark Peploe, Peter cowrote the screenplay for Michelangelo Antonioni's film *Professione: Reporter/The Passenger* (Italy, Spain, France,*

1975), and he also wrote and directed five feature films with Laura Mulvey, including *Riddles of the Sphinx* (United Kingdom, 1976). Peter's only solo feature, *Friendship's Death* (United Kingdom, 1987), starred Tilda Swinton as an alien cyborg in her second film. Peter's curatorial projects include the first international exhibition of Frida Kahlo and Tina Modotti (1983), which coincided with Hayden Herrera's biography, leading inexorably to what he described in a reflective essay as "Fridamania" (2003). After taking a full-time teaching position at UCLA in 1988, Peter had more time to write about all sorts of things, and here are four examples of his wide-ranging interests and enthusiasms. These four essays were originally published in the journal *Emergences: Journal for the Study of Media and Composite Cultures*, a project initiated by graduate students at UCLA in the 1990s and edited by Vinay Lal and subsequently by Teshome Gabriel. When at the age of sixty-five early-onset Alzheimer's disease prevented him from continuing these intellectual pursuits, it was Teshome who said that losing Peter was like a library burning down.

7. Dolber, Brian. "Building class power in the platform age: (Re-)re-reading Mosco's Political Economy of Communication." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 351--365.

<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0013>.

ABSTRACT: Vincent Mosco (1996; 2009) describes three entry points into the study of political economy: commodification, spatialisation and structuration. During the last decades, these three processes have worked to make exploitation under platform capitalism ubiquitous. In response, scholar-activists have heeded Mosco's calls to centre class power. Through a range of qualitative approaches, researchers are developing relationships with platform workers based not in extraction but in solidarity. This article extends Mosco's legacy, arguing that the political economy of communication provides a useable analysis of our social totality in a moment of deep crisis.

8. Ellis, Patrick. "Barthes on Steinberg: Panorama, play, paradox." *Animation* 21, no. 2 (2026): 109--127. <https://doi.org/10.1177/17468477261455317>.

ABSTRACT: In 1976, the critic Roland Barthes wrote a manuscript in appreciation of the artist Saul Steinberg, ultimately published in 1983 as *All Except You*. In this article, the author argues that this little-known volume demonstrates the utility of Barthes for the study of animation. With a focus on pre-cinematic media, including panoramas and optical toys, the author emphasizes Barthes' reflections on animation, metamorphosis, and perspective. Reliant upon archival materials accessible only at the Beinecke Library and the Bibliothèque nationale de France, and including new

translations of passages from *All Except You*, it is further proposed that a single missing typographical mark helps us to better understand Barthes' animatic understanding of Steinberg.

9. Forde, Sydney L., and Mandy Tröger. "Communications 'outside of the mainstream': Reflections on Vincent Mosco's class consciousness." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 225--239.
<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0004>.

ABSTRACT: *In this article, we reflect on the legacy of Vincent Mosco and the critical political economy of communications (CPEC) to argue that class remains strikingly under-acknowledged as a structuring force within academia, specifically in the field of communications. As first-generation female scholars navigating the predominantly white, male-dominated subfields of political economy, journalism, and media policy, we draw on Mosco's self-reflective scholarship to examine the class contradictions of contemporary academic life. We advance three interconnected claims: that class and material conditions – alongside intersecting axes of marginalisation – continue to shape access to and dynamics within the academy; that mentorship grounded in class consciousness is central to sustaining critical intellectual communities; and that critical scholarship must engage with the contradictions of societies that profess equality while deepening class division. In a political moment marked by austerity, precarity and rising authoritarianism, we contend that expanding class diversity within CPEC is not merely representational but strategic – strengthening the field's capacity to resist threats to democratic life.*

10. Gregg, Ronald. "Close up, late silent film, and queer spectatorship." *Framework: The Journal of Cinema and Media* 66, no. 1 (2025): 83--97.
<https://doi.org/10.1353/frm.2025.a994386>.

ABSTRACT: *[first paragraph, in lieu of abstract] Between 1927 and 1933, the pioneering film journal Close Up offered an advanced theoretical, industrial, political, and psychoanalytic analysis of cinema, advocating for the development of a transnational avant-garde cinema "to reassemble / and to readjust" the world, as H.D. saw the possibilities in cinema in her poem "Projector," breaking down boundaries of nation, class, race, and gender (figure 1). In the introduction to Close Up 1927–1933: Cinema and Modernism, Anne Friedberg offers a taste of the historical wide-ranging treatment of cinema in the journal.*

11. Herman, Andrew, and Vincent Manzerolle. "Between lament and utopia: Vincent Mosco, Canadian political economy, and the haunting of the Silicon Valley uncanny." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026):

604--621. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0029>.

ABSTRACT: *This article situates Vincent Mosco's political economy of communication within the Canadian intellectual tradition of lament about technological dependency and American imperial power. Tracing a lineage from Harold Innis, George Grant and Dallas Smythe through to the neoliberal era of continental integration, we argue that Canadian tech policy during this period was haunted by the 'Silicon Valley uncanny' – an anxious and ultimately untenable identification with an imaginary rooted in the specific geopolitical conditions of American hegemony. Drawing on Mosco's concepts of the digital sublime and his transdisciplinary political economy of communication, we examine the Waterloo Region's tech ecosystem and Communitech's 'Tech for Good' initiative as case studies in how Canadian tech culture has sought to articulate other values within this imaginary. The collapse of the neoliberal rules-based order and the re-emergence of American coercive power demand a renewed critical political economy of Canadian technological nationalism, one adequate to the present conjuncture and open, as Mosco insisted, to the possibility of utopia.*

12. Jin, Dal Yong. "Epistemologies of critical political economy in the era of digital platforms and AI." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 288--302. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0008>.

ABSTRACT: *As a contribution to this special issue on Vincent Mosco's contributions to current and future directions in communication studies, this article discusses how critical political economy analyses digital platforms and AI, which have become the primary actors in the cultural industries. It primarily draws on three major epistemological perspectives (humanitarianism, social totality and history) advanced and actualised by Mosco for understanding digital platforms and AI. It aims not only to offer critical reflections on how media scholars can further develop Mosco's approaches in critical political economy but also to explore how political economists develop his perspectives in rapidly changing media environments.*

13. Kellas, Jody Koenig. "Communicated narrative sense-making theory: Assumptions, heuristics, propositions, elaborations, and operationalizations." *Journal of Family Communication* 26, no. 3 (2026): 246--267. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15267431.2026.2681976>.

ABSTRACT: *Communicated narrative sense-making theory (CNSM) examines the content, process, and application of stories, storytelling, and storylistening along with the connection between these practices and psychosocial and relational functioning. In this special issue celebrating the*

25th anniversary of the *Journal of Family Communication*, the current article offers a comprehensive and updated overview of CNSM theory's assumptions, heuristics, propositions, elaborations, and operationalizations with the overarching goals of guiding researchers on a path to studying storytelling and improving people's lives.

14. MacDonald, Scott. "The expanding audio-visioning of Lého Galibert-Laîné." *Quarterly Review of Film and Video* 43, no. 3 (2026): 579--600.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/10509208.2026.2647708>.

ABSTRACT: [first paragraph, in lieu of abstract] This title is a reference to "The Expanding Vision of Larry Gottheim's Films," my first published essay on independent cinema, which appeared in the Spring 1978 issue of what was then the *Quarterly Review of Film Studies*. I became aware of Lého Galibert-Laîné's video essay work by sheer dumb luck. A filmmaker friend, J.P. Sniadecki, emailed me to say that I was referenced in a video essay called *Forensickness* (2020) that was available on-line at Galibert-Laîné's website. Curious as to what the reference might be, I found my way to the website, and to *Forensickness*—an analysis of Chris Kennedy's *Watching the Detectives* (2017), an exploration of Reddit postings during the immediate wake of the 2013 Boston Marathon bombing. Galibert-Laîné's video essay included a brief moment when Kennedy and filmmaker/interviewer Mike Hoolboom debated the comparative value of my long-time term for avant-garde cinema, "critical cinema," and Hoolboom's term for that dimension of film history, "fringe film."

15. McKercher, Catherine, Leslie Regan Shade, Nicole S. Cohen, and Ursula Elin Huws. "Rethinking and renewing Vincent Mosco's political economy of communication." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 189--202. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0001>.

ABSTRACT: This special issue presents articles exploring the remarkable intellectual legacy of Vincent Mosco: his theoretical innovations in political economy, including his foundational role in the development of the political economy of communication; his contributions to teaching, research, mentorship and praxis; his material analysis of media labour; his identification of risks associated with digitalisation; his prescience about the implications of AI; and his focus on the need to imagine concrete utopias as ways to make a better world.

16. McLaren, Rachel M., Denise Haunani Solomon, Leanne K. Knobloch, and Jennifer A. Theiss. "The study of relational turbulence theory in families: Reflections on the past and visions for the future." *Journal of Family*

Communication 26, no. 3 (2026): 231--245.

<https://doi.org/10.1080/15267431.2026.2658450>.

ABSTRACT: *The first issue of the Journal of Family Communication was published in 2001, the same year as the publication of the inaugural study investigating processes of relational turbulence. To mark the 25th anniversary of both events, we consider the applicability of relational turbulence theory beyond its original focus on romantic relationships to family relationships. We trace research on relational turbulence from dating relationships to marital relationships to non-marital dyads in the family, theorize about the relevance of the theory's key constructs in family contexts, and delineate implications for both research and practice. Our synthesis emphasizes points of both convergence and divergence in relational turbulence processes within romantic dyads versus family systems. Along the way, we identify opportunities for future research to usher in a new era of scholarship on relational turbulence and family communication.*

17. Murdock, Graham. "The algorithmic sublime: Myth, power and artificial intelligence." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 527--542. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0025>.

ABSTRACT: *In his landmark book *The Digital Sublime* (2004), Vincent (Vinny) Mosco crafted one of the earliest and most devastating demolitions of the false promises of universal betterment promoted by the major corporations that had annexed the internet in the interests of profit. His later work, *To the Cloud*, (2014) built on this critique with a pioneering analysis of the concentrated material and economic power coalescing around the data centres directing digital applications, underlining their escalating social costs and environmental damage. This article revisits Vinny's writings demonstrating their continuing and essential relevance to the emerging landscape of artificial intelligence.*

18. Pickard, Victor. "Pointing toward utopia: Vincent Mosco's final chapter." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 633--641. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0031>.

ABSTRACT: *In the final chapter of his last book, Vincent Mosco explored the concept of 'utopia', seeing it as a vital necessity for imagining alternative democratic futures. This article situates Mosco's work within a larger body of leftist thinking, suggesting that articulating radical imaginaries beyond capitalism will remain a key aspect of his legacy as well as a necessary project for critical political economists going forward. This broader context is especially important given that the political economic tradition of*

communication research that Mosco did so much to establish is undergoing a generational shift, which calls for deep reflection about the field's future trajectory.

19. Prodnik, Jernej A. "Periodising the political economy of communication: A proposal." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 240–260. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0005>.

ABSTRACT: This article proposes that the history of the Political Economy of Communication can be divided into five distinct periods. A summary of the defining features and leading thinkers of these phases is provided, together with the main contextual factors that shaped each period. Given that political economy has historically had a political stance and been a central critical approach in communication studies, its development has been clearly influenced by these changing historical conditions. The proposed chronology provides a synthesis, as opposed to an exhaustive literature review, and complements Vincent Mosco's historical account, situating him as a key author adopting and defining the approach.

20. Rubinsky, Valerie, Angela Cooke-Jackson, and Haley Kranstuber Horstman. "Evolution and future directions for the theory of memorable messages in family communication." *Journal of Family Communication* 26, no. 3 (2026): 284--295. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15267431.2026.2671047>.

ABSTRACT: This article reviews the historical and recent approaches to understanding memorable messages in the context of families. Theoretical and atheoretical approaches to memorable message research are explored, with special attention to the emerging Theory of Memorable Messages (ToMM) and its recent family communication scholarship. The authors elaborate and offer recommendations for future directions and practical applications for ToMM scholarship in the family.

21. Smeltzer, Sandra. "The force of an activist-scholar: Labour and community engagement." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 327--336. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0011>.

ABSTRACT: This article highlights the impact of Vincent Mosco's life work on the author's labour-oriented scholarship and activism. Drawing on Mosco's extensive oeuvre, the discussion emphasises that labour considerations must forefront critical analyses of community-based forms of experiential learning. These curricular, hands-on experiences of community engaged learning are geared towards fostering the public good and premised on an ethos of reciprocity with community partners. The article focuses attention specifically on the Canadian university ecosystem and the

ways in which Mosco's work offers invaluable insights into our understanding of how to advance such public good praxis within neoliberal institutions of higher education.

22. Stevens, Andrew Robert. "Deploying political economy: Lessons on conviction, mentorship and political struggle." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 215--224.
<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0003>.

ABSTRACT: Political economist and communications scholar Vincent (Vinny) Mosco provided mentorship to several generations of students and aspiring academics. He believed in the power of personal narratives to render complex ideas accessible so that we might better understand social processes and structures that constitute our lived realities. For some of us, his teachings would inspire dual paths of scholarship and political activism aimed at creating the conditions for progressive social and economic change. In this paper in honour of Vinny, I discuss how my former supervisor's guidance helped me mobilise political economy to both understand and challenge institutional power.

23. Sussman, Gerald Jay. "Vincent Mosco ¡Presentel!: A personal and professional chronicle." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 203--214. <https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0002>.

ABSTRACT: This essay discusses the work of Vincent Mosco, presenting a brief historiographic analysis of his ideas, and describing how he in turn influenced my writing (and many others) and the course of my academic career. Within the text and references, I cite core ideas and key works of Herbert Schiller, Dallas Smythe and Mosco, all of whom were leaders in the field of critical communication research, Mosco belonging to the second generation of neo-Marxist scholars in the field. I also cite my own publications that flowed from the influence of these foundational thinkers and discuss the small contributions I've had the honour of contributing to Professor Mosco's own publishing oeuvre in parallel pursuit of critical analysis of communications as a system of power.

24. Villagrán Sánchez, Álvaro, and Fernando López Pan. "Journalism, the sociology of knowledge, and science studies: A narrative literature review." *Journalism* 27, no. 7 (2026): 2029--2046.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/14648849251358911>.

ABSTRACT: Journalism's role in the production and legitimation of knowledge has received increasing attention at the intersection of journalism studies, sociology of knowledge, and science studies. This narrative review maps four key interdisciplinary intersections: collective

memory, paradigm repair, boundary work, and trading zones/boundary objects. It traces the historical foundations—from Halbwachs’s collective memory and Kuhn’s paradigms to Gieryn’s boundary work and Galison’s trading zones—and examines how these concepts have been applied in journalism studies. These distinct but complementary research traditions show that journalism serves as an active “agent of memory,” shaping what societies and communities remember and forget; that journalists engage in discursive practices of paradigm repair to restore professional legitimacy when norms are violated; and that boundary work strategies are used to delineate journalistic jurisdiction. It also shows how trading zones and boundary objects enable collaboration between journalists and other expert communities. In each area, we balance theoretical contributions with empirical studies and highlight critical debates. A common thread running through the four areas examined is how journalism maintains and negotiates its cultural and epistemic authority as a knowledge-producing practice in an evolving media landscape.

25. Wasko, Janet, and Jeremy L. Swartz. "Towards topos." *Work Organisation, Labour & Globalisation* 20, no. 2 (2026): 622--632.

<https://doi.org/10.13169/workorglaboglob.20.2.0030>.

ABSTRACT: *This remembrance and speculative inquiry is inspired by dialogues with Vincent Mosco regarding the last chapter of his memoir and while he was preparing a monograph on desire and utopia/dystopia. We contend that any discussions of words derived from the suffix ‘-topia’ must take root in the concept of ‘topos’, which provides a stronger grounding from which to explore abstract and concrete meanings and contexts for these terms. We offer an overview of the often confusing and problematic history of their uses, as well as suggestions for an expansive conceptualisation and trajectories for (re)imagining and (re)building plural futures.*

Thanks for reading! The History of Media Studies Newsletter, a monthly email assembled by Dave Park, Jeff Pooley, and Pete Simonson, maintains a loose affiliation with the *History of Media Studies* journal and the **Working Group on the History of Media Studies**. Please **contact us** with any questions, suggestions, or items.

This is the July 2026 issue of *History of Media Studies Newsletter*. You can **subscribe** or **unsubscribe**.